



National Institute of
Diabetes and Digestive
and Kidney Diseases

Gestational Diabetes

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Definition & Facts

Gestational diabetes is a type of diabetes that occurs only during pregnancy. Gestational diabetes can cause health problems in both mother and baby. Managing your diabetes can help protect you and your baby.



Symptoms & Causes

Gestational diabetes often has no symptoms, or they may be mild, such as being thirstier than normal or having to urinate more often. Gestational diabetes is sometimes related to the hormonal changes of pregnancy that make your body less able to use insulin. Genes and extra weight may also play a role.

Tests & Diagnosis

Your doctor will test you for gestational diabetes between 24 and 28 weeks of pregnancy. Tests include the glucose challenge test and the oral glucose tolerance test (OGTT). If the results of the glucose challenge test show high blood glucose, you will return for an OGTT test to confirm the diagnosis of gestational diabetes.

Management & Treatment

Managing gestational diabetes includes following a healthy eating plan and being physically active. If your eating plan and physical

Prevention

You can lower your chance of getting gestational diabetes by losing extra weight before you get pregnant if you are overweight. Being

activity aren't enough to keep your blood glucose in your target range, you may need insulin.

physically active before and during pregnancy also may help prevent gestational diabetes.

After Your Baby is Born

If you had gestational diabetes, you are more likely to develop type 2 diabetes. Your child is more likely to have obesity or develop type 2 diabetes. You may be able to lower your and your child's chances of developing these problems by reaching a healthy weight, making healthy food choices, and being physically active.

Related Conditions & Diseases

- [Health Tips for Pregnant Women](#)
- [Type 2 Diabetes](#)

Clinical Trials

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Related Research

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